



# Data Day 2027 — Program & Schedule (DRAFT)

**Theme:** Plotting What's Next — *Five years forward for Central Ohio's data community* **Event:** Data Day 2027 — 5th annual **Date:** Tuesday, February 16, 2027 **Venue:** OSU Vitria on the Square, 14 E. 15th Ave., Columbus, OH 43201 **Window:** 8:00 AM – 4:00 PM (program content ~8:45 AM – 3:35 PM)

Status: **Working draft for discussion.** Layout decisions resolved; remaining venue confirmations noted at the bottom.

## Rooms & capacities

The four rooms are **fixed for the whole conference** — the Grand Ballroom divider stays in place all day, so every room is available continuously with no reconfiguration. The **Grand Ballroom is set in banquet rounds the entire day** (full rounds): keynotes, ballroom breakouts, the Intern Showcase, and lunch all run from the same round-table setup, so there is never a seating flip.

| Room             | Capacity | Role in the program                                                       |
|------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Grand Ballroom   | 250      | Plenary, both keynotes, Intern Showcase; <b>lecture + panel</b> breakouts |
| Grand Ballroom B | 70       | <b>Technical workshop</b> sessions (hands-on)                             |
| Terrace A        | 100      | Standard <b>lecture</b> breakouts                                         |
| Terrace B        | 60       | Standard <b>lecture</b> breakouts                                         |

**Non-session spaces (active all day):** the **Gallery** hosts **vendor & organization tabling**, and **poster presentations** are displayed throughout the venue's circulation areas. These run continuously and are not scheduled as sessions — see *Throughout the day* below.

## Session types

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| Type                        | Length        | Room(s)                              | Notes                                       |
|-----------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Keynote                     | 45–50 min     | Grand Ballroom                       | Morning + lunch                             |
| Lecture                     | 45 min        | Grand Ballroom, Terrace A, Terrace B | Standard breakout                           |
| Panel                       | 45 min        | Grand Ballroom                       | Moderated, multi-speaker                    |
| Workshop                    | 90 min        | Grand Ballroom B                     | Hands-on/technical; spans 2 breakout blocks |
| Lightning / Intern Showcase | ~5–7 min each | Grand Ballroom                       | Plenary, during lunch                       |

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## Schedule

| Time        | Grand Ballroom (250)                                                         | Grand Ballroom B (70)               | Terrace A (100)   | Terrace B (60)    |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| 8:00–8:45   | Registration & coffee                                                        | —                                   | —                 | —                 |
| 8:45–9:00   | <b>Welcome &amp; opening</b> (plenary)                                       | —                                   | —                 | —                 |
| 9:00–9:50   | <b>Morning Keynote</b>                                                       | —                                   | —                 | —                 |
| 9:50–10:05  | <i>Break / transition</i>                                                    |                                     |                   |                   |
| 10:05–10:50 | Block 1 — Lecture/Panel                                                      | <b>Workshop A</b> (90 min, → 11:50) | Block 1 — Lecture | Block 1 — Lecture |
| 10:50–11:05 | <i>Break</i>                                                                 | <i>(workshop continues)</i>         | <i>Break</i>      | <i>Break</i>      |
| 11:05–11:50 | Block 2 — Lecture/Panel                                                      | <b>Workshop A</b> (cont.)           | Block 2 — Lecture | Block 2 — Lecture |
| 11:50–12:05 | <i>Break / transition to lunch</i>                                           |                                     |                   |                   |
| 12:05–1:35  | <b>Lunch + Intern Showcase + Lunch Keynote + thank-yous/extras</b> (plenary) | —                                   | —                 | —                 |
| 1:35–1:50   | <i>Break / transition</i>                                                    |                                     |                   |                   |
| 1:50–2:35   | Block 3 — Lecture/Panel                                                      | <b>Workshop B</b> (90 min, → 3:35)  | Block 3 — Lecture | Block 3 — Lecture |
| 2:35–2:50   | <i>Break</i>                                                                 | <i>(workshop continues)</i>         | <i>Break</i>      | <i>Break</i>      |
| 2:50–3:35   | Block 4 — Lecture/Panel                                                      | <b>Workshop B</b> (cont.)           | Block 4 — Lecture | Block 4 — Lecture |
| 3:35–4:00   | Adjourn / informal networking                                                |                                     |                   |                   |

**Lunch block (90 min) flow:** food served + **Intern Showcase** lightning round while people eat → **Lunch Keynote** as the focused closer → **thank-yous / sponsor recognition / 2028 teaser** fold in at the end of the keynote. (No separate end-of-day closing plenary.)

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## Throughout the day — exhibits & posters

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These run continuously alongside the session grid and use the Gallery and circulation areas, not the four session rooms.

- **Vendor & organization tabling — the Gallery.** Open all day; naturally trafficked during registration (8:00–8:45), every break, and lunch.
- **Poster presentations — throughout the venue.** Displayed all day. Suggest designating **attended poster times** (authors stand by their posters) during the long lunch block and the mid-morning/mid-afternoon breaks so attendees know when to engage.

## Two poster/intern pipelines feeding these

1. **Intern projects.** Interns submit their projects for presentation. A selection committee picks **a few for the Intern Showcase lightning talks** (lunch, plenary); the **remaining accepted projects become poster presentations**. One submission pool, two outcomes.
2. **Student poster CFP.** A **separate Call for Proposals for posters from area students** feeds the poster display alongside the intern posters.

**Note for the CFP / logistics:** both pipelines need submission deadlines, a selection/review step, poster size/format specs, easel or board counts, and assigned display locations. The intern CFP must flag that submitting means *either* a lightning talk *or* a poster.

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## What this yields

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- **2 keynotes** (morning + lunch)
- **1 Intern Showcase** lightning round (plenary, over lunch)
- **14 breakout sessions:**
  - Grand Ballroom: 4 (lecture/panel mix)
  - Terrace A: 4 lectures
  - Terrace B: 4 lectures
  - Grand Ballroom B: 2 workshops (90 min each — one morning, one afternoon)
- **4 concurrent breakout choices** in every block

- **All day:** vendor/organization tabling in the Gallery + poster presentations (intern projects not selected for lightning talks, plus student-CFP posters) throughout the venue

**Peak concurrent breakout capacity:**  $250 + 70 + 100 + 60 = 480$  seats across 4 rooms per block — well above 250 attendance, leaving headroom for popular-session overflow.

**Workshop alignment:** each 90-min workshop spans both blocks in its half-day and ends exactly when the second lecture block ends, so the grid stays in sync (2 workshops vs. 4 lectures per other room). Workshops run **continuous** through the lecture-room break, with a facilitator-called informal in-room break.

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## Resolved layout decisions

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1. **Ballroom seating: full banquet rounds** all day (max capacity; no seating flip).
2. **Workshops: continuous 90 min** with classroom tables + power and an informal in-room break.
3. **Lunch ordering:** Intern Showcase during eating → Lunch Keynote as closer → thank-yous/extras.
4. **Closing: no separate closing plenary;** recognition folded into the end of the lunch keynote. Morning keynote starts at **9:00**, with extra time built in around lunch.

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## Remaining venue confirmations

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- **Ballroom B (workshops):** confirm laptop/classroom tables, power drops, and AV support for hands-on content.
- **Divider reset:** none required — confirm the divider can simply stay in place all day.
- **Catering timing:** confirm lunch can be served into rounds at the 11:50 transition without disrupting the 12:05 program start.

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## Alternatives worth considering

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- **Panels as an anchor:** schedule the ballroom's larger-draw **panels** opposite the workshops so the two “marquee” formats don't compete for the same audience.
- **5-block dense version:** add a breakout block (~20 sessions) if the call for proposals over-subscribes; trades slack for volume.
- **Uniform-45-min fallback:** if 90-min workshops prove hard to fill, run **45-min** workshops in Ballroom B (4 total) for a fully uniform grid.